

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Dominic Howard

Address: 38 Barrington Road Sutton SM3 9PP

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally object to the above planning application on the following planning and infrastructure grounds.

1. Insufficient Parking Provision

The proposed development is likely to generate a significant increase in vehicle movements, particularly during peak worship periods and community events.

The surrounding residential streets already experience parking pressure, and the application does not demonstrate adequate off-street parking provision to accommodate anticipated visitor numbers. This risks:

- Increased congestion,
- Obstruction to emergency access,
- Displacement parking affecting local residents.

2. Impact on Local Highway Infrastructure

The local road network is primarily residential in character and not designed to accommodate large volumes of visitors arriving simultaneously.

High-frequency gathering times may result in traffic build-up, unsafe manoeuvring, and reduced pedestrian safety, particularly during evenings and weekends.

3. Pressure on Local Infrastructure

Under planning policy, developments must be supported by appropriate infrastructure capacity. The proposal may place additional strain on:

- Local transport routes,
- Waste collection services,
- Residential amenity,
- Public realm and noise environment.

The application does not sufficiently demonstrate how these impacts will be mitigated.

4. Residential Amenity and Noise

Regular large gatherings have the potential to increase noise levels, vehicle activity, and general disturbance inconsistent with the established residential nature of the area.

5. Community Integration and Inclusive Use

While community facilities are welcomed in principle, developments should demonstrate broad accessibility and inclusive benefit for the whole local community. The proposal provides limited evidence of how the facility would serve the wider Sutton population beyond a single user group.

6. Cumulative Development Impact

Sutton is already experiencing significant development growth. The cumulative impact of additional high-intensity community buildings should be carefully assessed to ensure the borough's suburban character and residential balance are preserved, consistent with objectives within the Sutton Local Plan.